

ENG518 SHORT HANDOUTS

MIDTERM

Lesson 01 to 05

(ENG518) Research Methodology

EFFORT BY VUHELPERS24 TEAM

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Lesson-01

WHAT IS RESEARCH?

Topic-001: What is Research?

What is the main focus of the course on research methodology?

The course emphasizes each step involved in research methodology from identifying the research problem to developing a complete research study.

What are the objectives of the course on research methodology?

The course aims to help students understand research methods in English Language Teaching (ELT), critically evaluate research problems, formulate research questions, and present research proposals.

How is research defined?

Research is defined as a systematic inquiry that investigates hypotheses, suggests new interpretations of data, and poses new questions for future exploration.

What are the objectives of this research methodology course?

The course aims to help students understand fundamental research methods in English Language Teaching (ELT), critically evaluate research problems, formulate research questions and objectives, and develop major components of a research study, such as title, abstract, introduction, research design, discussion, and conclusion. It also involves presenting a research proposal and defending the research design.

Topic-002: Definitions of research

How do scientists generally use the term "research" in a scientific context?

In a scientific context, "research" typically refers to the entire scientific method, including all stages from start to finish.

What are some characteristics of research according to various definitions?

Research is described as a systematic and refined technique of thinking, a reliable, verifiable, and exhaustive process, and an intellectual process that seeks truth and new knowledge.

What is the broadest sense of the word "research" and its purpose?

In the broadest sense, research encompasses any formal gathering of data, information, and facts to advance knowledge. It's conducted with the researcher's intention and purpose, and it follows the scientific method from start to finish. The purpose is to add to scientific knowledge, engage in a reliable, verifiable, and exhaustive process, seek the discovery of truth, formulate hypotheses, collect and evaluate data, and reach conclusions.

Topic-003: General Characteristics of Research

What are the main characteristics of research?

Research is systematic, logical, empirical, reductive, replicable, and gathers new knowledge from primary sources. It emphasizes the discovery of general principles and uses valid data gathering devices.

How does research eliminate personal feelings and preferences?

Research resists the temptation to seek only data that supports hypotheses, emphasizing objective and logical investigation.

What are the key characteristics of research?

Research is systematic, logical, empirical, reductive, and replicable. It gathers new knowledge from primary sources, emphasizes the discovery of general principles, and involves exact, systematic, and accurate investigation using valid data gathering devices. It maintains logical and objective standards, resists the temptation to support only hypotheses, eliminates personal feelings and preferences, and is a patient, unhurried activity. Research is carefully recorded and reported, and conclusions and generalizations are made carefully and cautiously.

Topic-004: Functions of Research

What is the primary purpose of research?

Research seeks new knowledge for continuous improvement, refines existing knowledge, and provides baseline data for decision-making.

How does research impact human life?

Research improves various aspects of human life, such as learning, teaching, and decision-making in specific fields.

What is the primary function of research?

Research primarily seeks new knowledge for continuous improvement. It refines and extends existing knowledge, providing baseline data and facilitating decision-making in various fields. Additionally, research contributes to improving learning and teaching processes and various aspects of human life.

Topic-005: Specific Characteristics of ELT Research

Why is there a substantial amount of research in ELT (English Language Teaching)?

ELT research provides deep insight, imaginative problem-solving techniques, and a sound philosophy to improve teaching and learning.

Is ELT research interdisciplinary, and how does it bridge different fields?

ELT research is interdisciplinary, bridging fields like psychology (e.g., motivation and anxiety) and sociology (e.g., cultural assimilation and social varieties). It is not as exact as physical sciences and may involve subjectivity.

Why is there a significant amount of research in English Language Teaching (ELT)?

ELT research is extensive due to its sound philosophy, deep insights, and imaginative problem-solving techniques. It combines theoretical and applied research, aiming to enhance teaching and learning. ELT research, while not as exact as physical sciences, embraces subjectivity and is not restricted to specialists. It is an interdisciplinary field bridging psychology (e.g., motivation and anxiety) and sociology (e.g., cultural assimilation and social varieties). It offers a wide scope for exploration and knowledge generation.

Lesson-02

RESEARCH IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING (ELT) [APPLIED LINGUISTICS]

Topic-006: Identifying Important Questions in ELT

For whom is ELT research conducted, and who are the potential beneficiaries?

ELT research is conducted for various stakeholders, including students, teachers, administrators, parents, and other stakeholders in the field of English language teaching.

What are the key areas of concern in ELT research?

ELT research encompasses issues related to understanding language, students, teachers (ES/FL), administration, parents, and stakeholders.

What can be the potential topics of concern in ELT research?

Anything related to language and society, learning, teaching, management, decision making, and various aspects of English language teaching can be topics of concern in ELT research.

Topic-007: What is ELT Research About?

What domains of topics does ELT research cover?

ELT research covers vast domains, including language, practical issues, second or foreign language problems, and language policy.

What are some topics related to Applied Linguistics within ELT research?

Topics in Applied Linguistics, such as bilingualism, multilingualism, language education, assessment, and cross-cultural communication, are also part of ELT research.

Topic-008: Why is Research in ELT (AL) Important?

Why is research in ELT important?

Research in ELT is essential to address challenges related to the quality of learning and teaching, adapt to cultural and contextual variations in teaching methods, and understand learners and teachers' perspectives.

What are some key aspects that ELT research explores?

ELT research explores teaching methods, materials, assessment and evaluation, technology in classrooms, and the perspectives of learners and teachers.

Why is research in English Language Teaching (ELT) important?

Research in ELT is crucial because it addresses significant challenges related to the quality of learning and teaching in the field. It explores various teaching methods influenced by cultural, normative, policy, and contextual factors. Researchers study materials, ways of conveying information, methods of assessment and evaluation, and the integration of technology in the classroom. Additionally, research seeks to understand the perspectives of learners and teachers on educational issues at both linguistic and identity-tech incorporation levels.

Topic-009: Demythologizing Research

What are the characteristics of true research?

True research provides a clear understanding of meaning, is an earnest activity, helps solve problems, is carried out by skillful practitioners, follows a systematic research process, answers "What/why" questions, creates more questions, and involves data gathering, analysis, and drawing conclusions.

What are the characteristics of true research?

True research is characterized by providing a clear understanding of meaning, being an earnest activity, helping to solve problems, being carried out by skillful practitioners, following a systematic research process, addressing "What/why" questions, generating further questions, and involving the gathering, analysis, and drawing of conclusions from data.

Topic-010: Identifying Important Questions in ELT

How can research questions in ELT be formulated?

Research questions in ELT can be formulated through sources like practical problems, secondary sources (textbooks/theoretical papers), and primary research (sampling/design/discussions/recommendations).

How can individuals identify research questions in ELT?

Research questions in ELT can be identified through personal experiences, the use of secondary sources, reading discussion sections of related research, and considering their importance to others.

How are research questions in ELT created?

Research questions in ELT are typically created through various motivating forces, including practical problems, questions from secondary sources (textbooks/theoretical papers), and primary research (sampling, design, discussions, recommendations). These forces guide researchers in locating issues and forming important research questions.

How can individuals identify research questions in the field of teaching or learning?

Research questions in teaching or learning can be identified through personal experiences, the use of secondary sources like textbooks and theoretical papers, and by reading the discussion sections of related research. It's essential to consider the importance of these questions for others as well.

Lesson-03

CLASSIFICATION OF RESEARCH

Topic-011: Classification of Research

What are the two basic levels of research?

The two basic levels of research are basic and applied research.

What are the characteristics of basic research?

Characteristics of basic research include being theoretical, contributing to subject knowledge, having no immediate value, and being used for broader studies.

What are the characteristics of applied research?

Characteristics of applied research include focusing on action, solving problems, and specifying a problem.

Topic-012: Major Types of Research

What are the major types of research based on research objectives?

The major types of research based on research objectives are fundamental and action research.

What are the major types of research based on the nature of research?

The major types of research based on the nature of research are exploratory and confirmatory.

What are the major types of research based on data collection procedures?

The major types of research based on data collection procedures are qualitative and quantitative.

What are the major types of research based on the application of research?

The major types of research based on the application of research include longitudinal, cross-sectional, conceptual, and empirical research.

What are some other types of research mentioned in the lesson?

Other types of research mentioned in the lesson include educational research and historical research.

Topic-013: Educational Research

What does educational research emphasize in terms of educational theories and practices?

Educational research emphasizes influencing educational theories and practices.

In what areas are educational problems focused?

Educational problems are focused in the library and field.

What aspects of education does educational research concern itself with?

Educational research concerns educational philosophy, curriculum development, learning and teaching methods, and teacher education.

What are some key issues considered during educational research?

Key issues considered during educational research include teacher behavior, educational administration and supervision, educational technology, research with educational implications, and educational significance.

Topic-014: Scientific Ways to Solve Problems

What are the steps involved in solving problems using scientific methods?

The steps involved in solving problems using scientific methods are developing the problem, forming the hypothesis, gathering data, analyzing and interpreting data, and reaching a conclusion.

Topic-015: Characteristics of an Investigator

What are some characteristics of an effective investigator or researcher?

Characteristics of an effective investigator/researcher include a full understanding of functions and activities, reflective thinking, sensitivity toward the job, creativity, knowledge of action research, insightfulness, a scientific attitude, objectivity in thinking, democratic behavior, patience, knowledge of measuring tools, open-mindedness, and excellence in the job.

Lesson-04

ASSORTMENT OF A PROBLEM

Topic-016: Assortment of a Problem

What is the first step in research?

The first step in research is the selection of a problem.

What are the components of reflective thinking?

Reflective thinking involves the occurrence of a problem, definition, explanation, elaboration, collection, and conclusion.

What does scientific thinking involve?

Scientific thinking involves inductive-deductive reasoning, cause and effect analysis, and assumption/hypothesis/objective/data-driven approaches.

Topic-017: Identification of a Problem

Why is the identification of a problem considered the first and most crucial step in research?

Identifying a problem is crucial because it lays the foundation for the entire research process.

What should a researcher know to identify a problem effectively?

A researcher should know the exact nature and dimensions of the problem, the research field, mastery of the area, basis for literary survey, priority field of study, definitions/analogies, and specific aspects of the problem.

Name some sources from which a researcher can find research problems.

Research problems can be found through personal experience, studying available literature, innovation (technological changes), discussions in professional circles, and secondary sources like publications and reports.

Topic-018: Criteria for the Selection of a Problem

What are the key points to consider before selecting a specific research problem?

Key points to consider before selecting a research problem include novelty, importance for the field, intellectual curiosity, personal qualifications, availability of data, special equipment and working conditions, approachability of the sample, sponsorship and administrative cooperation, cost, and time.

Why is it important to ensure the novelty of a research problem?

Ensuring novelty is crucial to avoid unnecessary duplication of research efforts.

Topic-019: Defining a Problem

Why is it necessary to define a research problem?

Defining a research problem sets the direction for the research, reveals the methodology, controls subjectivity, specifies variables, and makes the research work practicable.

What precautions should be taken in defining a research problem?

The problem definition should use specific words, be brief but comprehensive, recognize assumptions, have practical importance, and provide a certain rationale.

What are the steps involved in making a research problem?

The steps involve defining the problem, setting the conceptual framework, delimiting the elements, specifying the elements, and identifying key points.

Topic-020: Statement of a Problem

What is a problem statement in research?

A problem statement is the description of an existing issue that needs to be addressed and provides context for the research study.

What are the three criteria for a good problem statement?

A good problem statement should be concerned with variables involved, clear and unambiguous, and amenable to empirical testing.

Lesson-05

FOUNDATION OF A HYPOTHESIS

Topic-021: Foundation of a Hypothesis

What is the second step in research after developing a research problem?

The second step in research is the formulation of a hypothesis, which involves devising a tentative solution to the problem.

How can a hypothesis be described?

A hypothesis is a presumptive statement or proposition, a brilliant guess about the solution temporarily accepted as true.

Topic-022: Assumption, Postulate, and Hypothesis

What is an assumption in research?

An assumption is a belief that we consider true, even though there's insufficient empirical evidence to support it. It influences the development of theories and research instruments.

What is a postulate in the context of scientific research?

Postulates are fundamental beliefs accepted at face value, serving as working principles to start scientific work and discover other things.

How is a hypothesis different from assumptions and postulates?

A hypothesis is a specific, testable prediction about the relationship between variables, whereas assumptions are beliefs without empirical evidence, and postulates are fundamental working beliefs.

Topic-023: Functions and Importance of a Hypothesis

What is one function of a hypothesis in research?

One function of a hypothesis is to provide a temporary solution to a problem.

Why is a hypothesis considered the "eyes of the investigator"?

A hypothesis guides the research, acts as a focal point, and helps the investigator focus on specific goals.

Topic-024: Kinds of a Hypothesis

What are the two basic types of hypotheses?

The two basic types of hypotheses are relational and causal.

What is a Null (ND) Hypothesis?

The Null (ND) Hypothesis asserts that no relationship exists between the variables being studied.

What is a Directional Hypothesis?

A directional hypothesis predicts a specific direction for the relationship between variables.

How does a Declarative Hypothesis differ from other types of hypotheses?

A declarative hypothesis anticipates a relationship based on existing evidence.

Topic-025: Characteristics of a Good Hypothesis

What is one characteristic of a good hypothesis regarding universal laws?

A good hypothesis should not conflict with universal laws.

What is the significance of a hypothesis permitting deductive reasoning?

A hypothesis allowing deductive reasoning means it can lead to testable predictions and logical conclusions.

How does a good hypothesis control for verification?

A good hypothesis should be formulated in a way that allows for empirical verification through data collection and testing.